

Design System Document

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Status: Draft for design approval

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1. Design purpose

Create an aesthetic that feels like a premium magazine while remaining warm, legible, culturally respectful, and easy to understand.

The design system must convert visual ambition into reusable rules. A beautiful one-off screen is not a design system.

2. Brand personality

- Warm.
- Calm.
- Trustworthy.
- Human.
- Curious.
- Respectful.
- Editorial.
- Scientifically clear.

Avoid:

- Clinical coldness.
- Shame.
- Sensationalism.
- Excessive decoration.
- Childish visual treatment for adult topics.
- Luxury styling that makes the product feel inaccessible.

3. Design principles

1. One dominant idea per screen.
2. Show meaning, not decoration.
3. Use visual hierarchy before motion.
4. Use motion only to explain change.
5. Preserve readable text at all sizes.
6. Pair colour with labels and shapes.
7. Prefer human illustration over frightening imagery.
8. Use consistent visual metaphors.
9. Keep action and help visible.
10. Make accessibility part of the visual language.

4. Design tokens

```
:root {
  --font-body: "Inter", system-ui, sans-serif;
  --font-display: "Fraunces", Georgia, serif;
  --font-ui: "Inter", system-ui, sans-serif;

  --color-paper: #fffaf0;
  --color-paper-deep: #f2eadb;
  --color-ink: #182027;
  --color-ink-muted: #52616b;
  --color-teal: #0b6b67;
  --color-teal-dark: #064946;
  --color-orange: #f29f58;
  --color-blue: #3b82a0;
  --color-mint: #d8eee6;
  --color-warning: #b86b27;
  --color-danger: #a63d40;
  --color-focus: #1d62d1;
  --color-white: #ffffff;
  --color-border: #d9dedb;

  --space-1: 0.25rem;
  --space-2: 0.5rem;
  --space-3: 0.75rem;
  --space-4: 1rem;
  --space-6: 1.5rem;
  --space-8: 2rem;
  --space-12: 3rem;
  --space-16: 4rem;

  --radius-sm: 0.35rem;
  --radius-md: 0.75rem;
  --radius-lg: 1.5rem;

  --shadow-page: 0 1rem 2.5rem rgb(24 32 39 / 0.18);
```

```
--shadow-card: 0 0.5rem 1.5rem rgb(24 32 39 / 0.1);  
}
```

These are starting values. Final values require contrast, script, and device validation.

5. Colour semantics

Token	Meaning	Usage
Teal	Trust and guidance	Primary actions and navigation
Mint	Calm explanation	Background surfaces
Orange	Attention and action	Highlights and action cards
Blue	Services and information	Help and referral surfaces
Warning	Caution	Important note with text label
Danger	Urgent attention	Approved urgent-care notice only

Never use colour as the only way to communicate status.

6. Contrast requirements

- Test text against every background.
- Test large display type separately from body type.
- Test focus rings on paper and dark surfaces.
- Test illustrations in grayscale and forced-colour conditions.
- Avoid low-opacity text for essential content.

7. Typography

Display

Use a distinctive editorial serif or humanist display face for chapter openings, provided the required scripts are supported or paired with an appropriate local-script face.

Body

Use a highly legible sans-serif or humanist face with:

- Broad glyph coverage.
- Clear distinction between similar characters.
- Multiple weights.
- Good rendering on low-resolution screens.

Rules

- Do not use thin body weights.
- Use generous line height.
- Avoid long justified text blocks.
- Permit user scaling.
- Test translation expansion.
- Never put essential text only inside images.

8. Spacing and layout

Use a consistent spacing scale. Editorial layouts may break the grid intentionally, but alignment should remain understandable.

Recommended layout rules:

- Establish a clear reading column.
- Keep primary content within a comfortable width.
- Use generous margins around important messages.
- Avoid placing controls near the page fold.
- Reserve a consistent region for narration controls.

9. Illustration system

Style

- Hand-crafted vector linework.
- Soft, controlled gradients.
- Consistent stroke widths.
- Diverse, respectful human figures.
- Calm facial expressions.
- Abstract biological motifs where useful.
- No humiliating visual stereotypes.

Scene construction

Every scene contains:

- Background layer.
- Main subject layer.
- Explanation layer.
- Highlight layer.

- Label layer.
- Accessibility metadata.

Stable target IDs

```
scene-testing-clinic
scene-testing-clinic-door
scene-testing-clinic-health-worker
scene-testing-clinic-sample
scene-testing-clinic-results
```

10. Iconography

Icons must have:

- Consistent stroke width.
- Consistent corner treatment.
- Adequate size.
- Accessible label.
- Text label where meaning is not universal.

Avoid ambiguous medical symbols and icons that imply diagnosis.

11. Page materials

Use paper texture carefully:

- Very low contrast.
- Optimized file size.
- No texture over essential text.
- Static fallback available.
- Disabled in lite mode if necessary.

Page realism may include:

- Spine shadow.
- Edge shading.
- Subtle crease.
- Page curl.
- Paper grain.
- Ambient shadow.

12. Editorial templates

Cover

- Title.
- One clear image or visual composition.
- Edition information.
- Start action.
- Language control.

Explanation spread

- Visual on one side.
- Short explanation on the other.
- Audio and transcript controls.
- Focus target list.

Myth/fact spread

- One claim.
- Clear answer.
- Short reason.
- Optional deeper explanation.

Clinic journey spread

- Sequential steps.
- One sentence per step.
- Calm visual treatment.
- Clear expectations.

Action spread

- What to do.
- Where to seek support.
- What to expect.
- Privacy reassurance.

13. Component styles

Button

- Clear verb.
- High contrast.
- Visible focus.
- Large touch target.
- Loading and disabled states.

Card

- One primary message.
- Short supporting text.
- Clear hierarchy.
- Avoid dense card grids.

Audio control

- Play/pause is prominent.
- Progress is visible.
- Transcript is nearby.
- Speed is labelled.

Action card

- Action title.
- Simple explanation.
- Service or next-step information.
- No diagnosis language.

14. Motion language

Page turn

Tactile, deliberate, and short enough not to delay reading.

Target focus

Soft glow, outline, or trace. Never a rapid flashing effect.

Reveal

Use when the user is being shown a sequence or hidden relationship.

Background

Nearly static. Background motion must not compete with narration or reading.

Respect reduced-motion preferences using `prefers-reduced-motion`. [web:23][web:24]

15. Design review checklist

- Is the main message visible quickly?
- Is the layout understandable in the selected language?
- Does the scene work without motion?
- Does the scene work without colour?
- Is the action visible?
- Is the design respectful?
- Does the illustration avoid diagnostic implication?
- Is text readable at increased size?
- Is the visual hierarchy consistent?
- Does the component work on low-end devices?

16. Design acceptance criteria

The design system is ready when:

- Tokens are documented.
- Components have states.
- Typography works in launch locales.
- Contrast is tested.
- Core page templates exist.
- Illustration target conventions exist.
- Motion and reduced-motion rules exist.
- Lite-mode visual rules exist.
- Design review checklist is used on prototype screens.